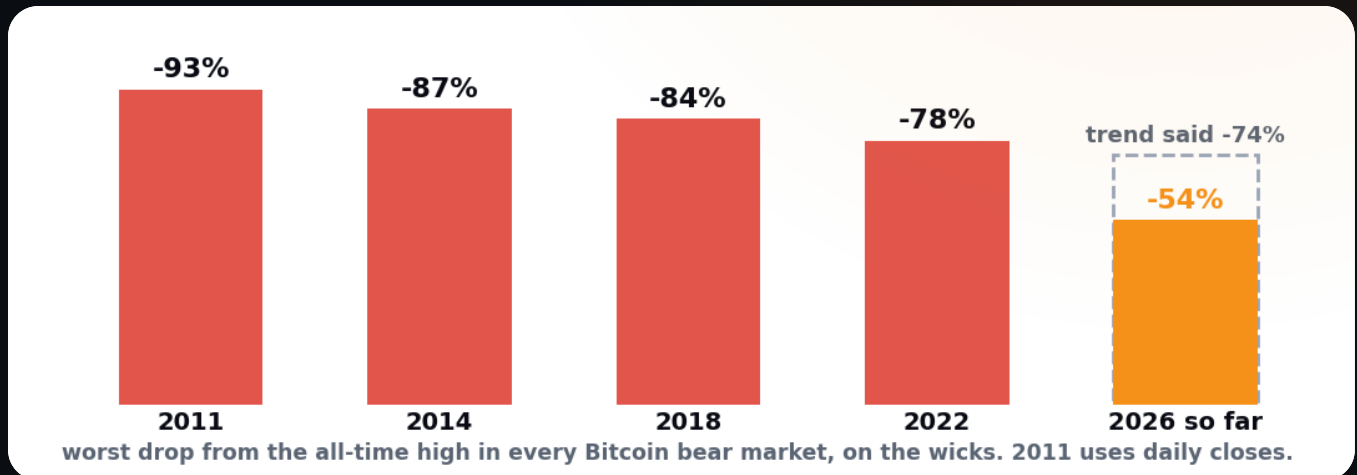


THE SHALLOW BEAR STUDY

Every Bitcoin bear market measured from the all-time high to the lowest wick, five of them, and whether the crashes really are getting smaller.

Where the trend said this bear would bottom, where it actually stopped, and the one test in the record that says it may not be finished.



-54%

the 2026 bear so far, against
-78% in 2022

day 268

when the 2026 low printed,
the fastest since 2011

3 of 3

bears since 2013 whose
day-268 low was not the
final low

Educational, not financial advice. Five bear markets is five data points. Every top and bottom is printed with its date and price so you can check each one.



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THE RULE

HOW A BEAR WAS MEASURED

The top. The all-time high, on the daily wick. **The bottom.** The lowest daily wick before that high is taken out again. **The drop.** Bottom against top. **Time.** Days from the top to the bottom, and days from the bottom until price reclaimed the old high.

Data. Bitstamp BTC/USD daily candles from August 2011. The first bear, June to November 2011, happened before Bitstamp existed, so it is measured on Coin Metrics daily closes and flagged. Its wick low on the exchanges of the time was lower still.

The trend. A straight line through the four finished bears, 2011, 2014, 2018 and 2022, projected one cycle forward. A second fit in log terms gives a slightly shallower projection. Both are printed.

EVERY BEAR

ALL FIVE, TOP TO BOTTOM

BEAR	TOP	TOP PRICE	BOTTOM	BOTTOM PRICE	DROP	DAYS TO BOTTOM	DAYS BOTTOM TO OLD HIGH	MEASURED ON
2011	08 Jun 2011	\$29.03	18 Nov 2011	\$2.11	-92.7%	163	460	closes
2014	30 Nov 2013	\$1,163	14 Jan 2015	\$152	-86.9%	410	771	wicks
2018	17 Dec 2017	\$19,666	15 Dec 2018	\$3,122	-84.1%	363	716	wicks
2022	10 Nov 2021	\$69,000	21 Nov 2022	\$15,479	-77.6%	376	470	wicks
2026	06 Oct 2025	\$126,272	01 Jul 2026	\$57,735	-54.3%	268	not yet	wicks

Bears are named for the year they bottomed. 2011 uses daily closes; every other row is wicks.

The four finished bears fell 93%, 87%, 84% and 78%. That is about five points shallower each cycle, the pattern behind 'the crashes are getting smaller'. It is real in the record. It also took between 460 and 771 days after each bottom for price to get back to the old high.

THE TREND

WHERE THE LINE POINTED

FIT THROUGH THE FOUR FINISHED BEARS	PROJECTED DROP	FROM THE \$126,272 TOP
Straight line, 2014 to 2022 (wicks only)	-73.5%	\$33,400
Log fit, 2014 to 2022 (wicks only)	-71.4%	\$36,100
Straight line, all four incl. 2011 closes	-73.3%	\$33,800
Log fit, all four incl. 2011 closes	-66.8%	\$41,900

Shallower/sh_study.py. The wick-only fits are the ones used on the slides.

Had this bear followed the trend on the wick data, it would have bottomed around \$33,000 to \$36,000. Adding the 2011 closes in a log fit pulls that up to about \$42,000. It stopped at \$57,735 on 1 July 2026, a drop of 54.3%. That is 23 points shallower than 2022, almost five cycles of the old shrinking rate in one step, and the shallowest Bitcoin bear market on record if the low holds.

It was also the fastest since 2011. The low printed 268 days after the top. The 2014, 2018 and 2022 bears took 410, 363 and 376 days.

THE CATCH

THE FIRST BIG LOW WAS **NOT** THE LAST



BEAR	WORST DROP BY DAY 268	FINAL DROP	FINAL LOW ON DAY	FURTHER FALL AFTER DAY 268
2014	-70.8%	-86.9%	410	-55%
2018	-70.6%	-84.1%	363	-46%
2022	-74.5%	-77.6%	376	-12%
2026	-54.3%	-54.3% so far	268	none yet

Further fall = the final low against the lowest low reached by day 268.

By day 268, the day the 2026 low printed, each of the last three bears had already fallen 71% to 75%. All three went lower later, and their final lows came between day 363 and day 410. 25 September 2026 is day 354 of this bear, so that window opens in the first week of October.

THE LIVE CASE

TWO READINGS, ONE LINE

DROP FROM THE \$126,272 TOP	PRICE
-54% (the 2026 low)	\$57,735
-60%	\$50,500
-65%	\$44,200
-70%	\$37,900
-74% (the trend)	\$33,400

Levels only. Not targets.

Reading one, the market changed. A bigger market with spot ETFs, corporate holders and deeper buyers gave a shallower, faster bear, and -54% was the bottom. The close above \$82,833 on 21 September, the first break of this bear's staircase of lower highs, fits this reading.

Reading two, the old pattern is still running. In every bear since 2013 the first big low was not the last, and the calendar window for a final low opens in October. This reading needs a new low under \$57,735.

THE READ

The break says the first reading. The calendar says do not rule out the second. \$57,735 is the line between them.

WHAT THIS STUDY DOES NOT SAY

Five bears. A straight line through four points is a description, not a law. The trend says what the past looked like, not what this bear owes.

The 2026 bear is not finished. A bear is only measured once the old high is reclaimed. Every 2026 number here is 'so far'.

Day counts are rough clocks. The final lows came 363 to 410 days after their tops in three cycles. Three is not a rule, and 2011 bottomed on day 163.

Different data, different numbers. Other exchanges print different wicks, most of all in 2011 and 2014. The shape of the answer does not change.

Data pinned 25 September 2026. Bitstamp BTC/USD daily wicks from August 2011, Coin Metrics closes for 2011. Scripts: Shallower/sh_study.py, sh_charts.py. This is education, not financial advice.

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